

DAY 2 POULTRY INTERMEDIATE LEVEL

AGRI_EMPOWER POULTRY BOOTCAMP: DAY 2

MODULE 1: PRODUCTION & FARM OPERATIONS (INTERMEDIATE)

GOAL: OPTIMIZE THE PHYSICAL PRODUCTION SYSTEM

At the Intermediate level, success is determined by the precision of your setup. A small mistake in feeder height or water temperature can lead to thousands in losses over a full cycle.

1. STOCKING DENSITY & SPACE PLANNING

- **The Science of Space:** At this level, we optimize for 10–12 birds per square meter (for broilers).
- **Practical Layout:** Ensure your pen is divided into functional zones. There should be a clear path for the attendant to walk without causing a "stampede," which leads to bird injuries and stress.
- **Expansion Plan:** Intermediate farmers must have a plan to "open up" the pen as birds grow to maintain optimal air quality and prevent wet litter.

2. FEEDER & DRINKER MANAGEMENT

- **The Ratio: * Drinkers:** 1 Bell Drinker per 75–100 birds.
 - **Feeders:** 1 Hanging Feeder per 50–75 birds.
- **Placement Strategy:** Never place all feeders in one corner and drinkers in another. Use a "checkerboard" pattern so a bird never has to walk more than 1.5 meters to find either food or water.
- **Height Regulation:** Feeders must be level with the bird's back. If too low, they scratch feed out (waste). If too high, smaller birds can't reach, leading to poor uniformity.

3. WATER: THE HIDDEN PERFORMANCE FACTOR

- **The 2:1 Rule:** Birds generally drink twice as much as they eat. If water is restricted or dirty, they will stop eating immediately.
- **Temperature Control:** In Nigeria's heat, water in tanks can reach 35°C+. Birds hate hot water.
 - *Action:* Shade your tanks. If the water is cool, the birds will drink more, eat more, and grow faster.
- **Potability:** If you cannot drink the water yourself, do not give it to your birds.

4. FEEDING STRATEGY & WASTE REDUCTION

- **Feed Timing: * Morning/Evening:** Give the bulk of the feed during the cooler hours.
 - **Afternoon "Fast":** During extreme heat (12 PM – 3 PM), it is often safer to withdraw feed to prevent "Metabolic Heat Stress" and sudden death.
- **Avoiding Wastage: *** Only fill feeders 1/3 to 1/2 full. Overfilling leads to birds "billing out" the feed onto the litter.
 - Keep litter dry. Wet litter around drinkers causes birds to waste feed because they are uncomfortable.

PRACTICAL WORKSHOP (CALCULATIONS)

Example 1: Feeders & Drinkers for 100 Birds

- **Requirement:** 1 Feeder per 50 birds; 1 Drinker per 100 birds.
- **Calculation: *** $100 / 50 = 2$ **Feeders**
 - $100 / 100 = 1$ **Bell Drinker** (or 2-3 manual gallon drinkers).

Example 2: Pen Arrangement (Drawing Concept)

Imagine your pen is a rectangle.

1. Place your Drinker in the dead center.
2. Place your 2 Feeders on opposite sides of the drinker.
3. This creates a "triangle of access" where birds can move freely between all points without crowding.